

show as some people do – the status or coolness factor of being seen hefting a PDA-phone is sometimes too much to resist.

Sony Ericsson XPERIA X10



I enquired about cheaper business-oriented phones, which pretty much means a QWERTY keypad, but I was interested in phones costing less than Rs. 15,000. The Blackberry Curve 8520 is priced below the Nokia E71, at Rs. 15,000 and seems like a decent option – though it's not as well built and the E71 has a better keypad. Nokia's own E63 is also available for as low as Rs. 11,500 and this is a neat deal for someone looking for a full QWERTY phone, as it's about the cheapest decent option available. It has a smaller battery and camera and is not as well built as the E71, but is a whole Rs. 5,000 or so cheaper. If you're looking for a cheap option, I recommend the Blackberry Curve 8520 and Nokia E63, depending on how much you can spend. As amazing as Blackberry's higher end phones are, I'm not a big fan because quite simply these aren't value-for-money and there is much better hardware on superior handsets available for the price commanded by the likes of the Blackberry Bold and the Curve 8900. Corporate users who think that push mail doesn't work as well on other handsets, please re-think, a Nokia E71, will give you the same level of usability for a much lower price. Obviously, features like Blackberry Messenger and such are useful, but the premium is hefty. Apple's own iPhone 3G available from carriers Vodafone and Airtel is, in my opinion not worth it. The handset is definitely good for multimedia and it's good as a phone, but for text and emailing, I do not like the lack of a hardware keypad. Additionally, with the latest firmware, the iPhone 3G slows down considerably and battery life also takes a slight toss.

I couldn't find anything in the malls or electronics stores that caught my fancy. Even the Sony Ericsson Satio with its lovely 3.5-inch display and the mighty 12-megapixel camera didn't seem as attractive. The fact is after having used Symbian for quite a while now, I'm ready for a change. I guess I'll postpone buying a phone till the XPERIA X10 launches, the idea of a 4-inch capacitive touchscreen is just too much to resist. Till then, my trusty old N95 8 GB will just have to suffice.

